

ISTQB FOUNDATION MASTERCLASS

12-Week Study Plan

A week-by-week route through the syllabus to exam day.

Overview

This plan spreads the ISTQB Foundation syllabus across twelve manageable weeks, roughly three to five hours each. It maps each week to a syllabus chapter, gives concrete activities, and builds in mock-exam checkpoints so you always know how ready you are. Adjust the pace to your schedule, but keep the mock checkpoints — they are how you measure progress.

The 12-Week Schedule

Week	Focus	Activities	Checkpoint
1	Ch.1 Fundamentals of testing	Read chapter; note the seven testing principles; learn key terms	Define testing vs debugging in your own words
2	Ch.1 continued	Test process and the psychology of testing; make flashcards	Score 70%+ on a Chapter 1 quiz
3	Ch.2 Testing throughout the SDLC	Compare development models; learn the four test levels	List the test levels and their objectives from memory
4	Ch.2 continued	Test types and maintenance testing; confirmation vs regression	Score 70%+ on a Chapter 2 quiz
5	Ch.3 Static testing	Reviews, review types, and the review process	Explain when static testing finds defects cheaply
6	Consolidation + Mock 1	Revise Chapters 1–3; sit a half-length mock	Mock 1 complete; log every wrong answer
7	Ch.4 Test analysis and design	Black-box: equivalence partitioning and boundary value analysis	Design test cases for a sample input field
8	Ch.4 continued	Decision tables, state transition, and use-case testing	Build a decision table for a small rule set
9	Ch.4 continued	White-box and experience-based techniques	Score 70%+ on a Chapter 4 quiz
10	Ch.5 Managing test activities	Planning, risk, monitoring, control, and defect management	Explain severity vs priority with an example

Week	Focus	Activities	Checkpoint
11	Ch.6 Test tools + Mock 2	Tool categories and benefits/risks; sit a full mock	Mock 2 complete; target 65%+ overall
12	Final revision + Mock 3	Revisit weak areas; sit a final timed full mock	Mock 3 at 75%+ — you are exam-ready

Mock-Exam Checkpoints

Three mocks are built in on purpose. Mock 1 is diagnostic — expect a modest score and use it to find gaps. Mock 2 measures real progress. Mock 3 should be under timed, exam-like conditions.

Mock	Week	Purpose	Target
Mock 1	6	Diagnostic — find weak areas early	Just complete it
Mock 2	11	Measure progress across all chapters	65%+
Mock 3	12	Final readiness under exam conditions	75%+

Weekly Rhythm

1. Read and summarise the chapter in your own words.
2. Make flashcards for the key terms and definitions.
3. Answer practice questions and log every wrong answer.
4. Re-attempt last week's wrong answers before moving on.

Milestones at a Glance

- End of Week 6 — Chapters 1–3 covered; first mock sat.
- End of Week 9 — Test design techniques mastered.
- End of Week 11 — Whole syllabus covered; second mock sat.
- End of Week 12 — Consistently scoring 75%+; book the exam.

If You Fall Behind

Do not abandon the plan — compress it. Combine the two lightest weeks, but never skip a mock checkpoint. The mocks are your early-warning system, and cutting them removes the one signal that tells you whether you are ready.

BEST PRACTICE

The pass mark is 65% (26 of 40). Aim to score consistently above 75% in your mocks before booking. That margin absorbs exam-day nerves and the occasional awkwardly worded question.

INSIDE STLC PRO TIP

Book your exam only after Mock 2. A fixed date is a powerful motivator, but booking it before you have proven your progress with a real mock risks paying to sit an exam you are not ready for.